100 Things About the 13th Child

For Charles Leone: born 13 October 1998, 21:25 UT, Johnstown, Pennsylvania. Youngest of thirteen children, born on Simchat Torah.

Every item below is a real tradition, text, date or finding, linked to a source. Chart positions come from this book's own calculations (`ch/`). Calendar conversions marked **[Calculated]** were computed for this page. Where a popular "thirteen" story turns out to be a modern invention, the entry says so.

I. The Day Itself: Calendars and Sky

1. **You were born on Simchat Torah.** Tuesday 13 October 1998 was 23 Tishrei 5759, Simchat Torah in the Diaspora, ending at nightfall that evening (Hebcal). You arrived on the festival of "Rejoicing in the Torah."
2. **The day the end meets the beginning.** On Simchat Torah the last portion of Deuteronomy (33:1–34:12, Moses' blessing and death) and the first of Genesis (1:1–2:3, Creation) are read back to back (Hebcal). The thirteenth and last child was born on the one day the scroll closes and opens again.
3. **An "eighth day" festival.** Simchat Torah belongs to Shemini Atzeret, the "Eighth Day of Assembly" added after the seven days of Sukkot (Wikipedia: Shemini Atzeret). It is a day past the complete set, the same way a thirteenth child comes after a full twelve.
4. **The Hebrew year can have thirteen months.** Seven years in every nineteen-year cycle add a second Adar, giving thirteen months (Wikipedia: Hebrew calendar). Thirteen is how the Jewish calendar realigns itself with the sun.
5. **Your Islamic birth date.** In the tabular Islamic calendar, 13 October 1998 is 21 Jumada al-Thani 1419 AH **[Calculated]** (local moon-sighting can shift it by a day; see Wikipedia: Tabular Islamic calendar).
6. **Your Persian birth date falls in Mehr.** In the Solar Hijri calendar it is 21 Mehr 1377 **[Calculated]**. Mehr is the month of Mithra, and its festival, Mehregan, is celebrated on 16 Mehr (Wikipedia: Mehregan). You were born in the week after the feast of covenant and friendship.
7. **Your Maya date.** Using the standard GMT correlation, your birthday is Long Count 12.19.5.10.17, tzolk'in 8 Kab'an (Earth), haab' 10 Yax **[Calculated]**, using the system described at Wikipedia: Mesoamerican Long Count calendar.
8. **A waning crescent at birth.** At 21:25 UT the Moon was 287° ahead of the Sun and about 35% lit **[Calculated, Skyfield DE421]**. That is a waning crescent. In Dane Rudhyar's eight-phase lunation cycle (Wikipedia: Dane Rudhyar) it falls in the last-quarter phase (270°–315°), the part of the cycle about re-orienting and gathering in what a cycle has produced. That suits the last-born of a large family.

9. **The real Sun was in Virgo too.** On 13 October the Sun sits within the IAU boundaries of the constellation Virgo, which the ecliptic crosses until late October (Wikipedia: Virgo (constellation)). Your sidereal Atmakaraka Sun in Virgo matches what the sky actually showed.
10. **The thirteenth sign is real astronomy, not astrology.** The ecliptic crosses thirteen IAU constellations, the thirteenth being Ophiuchus, the Serpent-Bearer (a healer figure). Astrology has always used twelve equal signs, and NASA said so in 2016 (Wikipedia: Ophiuchus (astrology)). Thirteen has always been the uncounted extra, which is exactly your place in the family.
11. **Some years have thirteen full moons.** A solar year is about 12.4 lunar months, so roughly every two to three years a thirteenth full moon appears. That extra one is the origin of the "blue moon" label (Wikipedia: Blue moon), and the same arithmetic drives the 19-year Metonic cycle (Wikipedia: Metonic cycle).
12. **Jupiter takes 11.86 years to circle the Sun** (Wikipedia: Jupiter). Your rising Jupiter in Pisces came back around 2010 (age about 12, a bar-mitzvah age) and again in 2022, and returns again around 2033–34.
13. **Your Saturn return is close.** Saturn comes back to its natal place about every 29.5 years (Wikipedia: Saturn return). Your Saturn, at 0° tropical Taurus in your third house of siblings, gets its return around 2028. That is the classic coming-of-age of adulthood, and in your chart it lands on the house of brothers and sisters.

II. Astrology, Every School

14. **Vedic: Kumbha (Aquarius) lagna, ruled by Saturn.** In Jyotish, Shani rules Aquarius and Capricorn (Wikipedia: Shani). Your whole life is steered by the planet of time, patience and the long line of elders.
15. **Vedic: Ketu rising.** Ketu, the lunar south node, signifies detachment and moksha (liberation) (Wikipedia: Ketu). The youngest, born after everyone else, carries the feeling of an ending.
16. **Vedic: Jupiter rising with Ketu.** Jupiter is Brihaspati, guru of the gods (Wikipedia: Brihaspati). A teacher-planet on the ascendant in both zodiacs is one of the strongest signatures in your chart.
17. **Moon in Pushya, "the nourisher."** Pushya is the 8th nakshatra (3°20′–16°40′ Cancer). Its deity is Brihaspati, its ruler Saturn and its symbol a cow's udder, and its Vedic name Tishya means "auspicious" (Drik Panchang). The Moon in a Brihaspati star, with Brihaspati also on the ascendant, makes Jupiter a double theme.
18. **Your Moon is in its own sign.** Pushya lies wholly in Karka (Cancer), the Moon's own sign (Drik Panchang). A child of a houseful of thirteen has a Moon at home.
19. **Sun as Atmakaraka.** In Jaimini astrology the Atmakaraka, "significator of the soul," is the planet at the highest degree within its sign (Wikipedia: Atmakaraka; Jaimini Sutram 1.1.11). Yours is the Sun, in Virgo: a soul set on standing in its own light and refining its craft.

20. **Saturn in Ashvini.** Ashvini is ruled by the Ashvins, the twin divine physicians (Wikipedia: Ashvini). Your Saturn, lord of your lagna, sits in a healers′ star.
21. **Saturn in its fall sign.** Classical tradition exalts Saturn in Libra, which puts its fall in Aries (Wikipedia: Exaltation (astrology)). Your sidereal Saturn in Aries works hard for what it builds, and you earn your authority.
22. **Mars and Rahu in the 7th.** Rahu is the eclipse-causing north node, associated with hunger and ambition (Wikipedia: Rahu). In the 7th house of partners and open rivals it puts fire and appetite into your one-to-one bonds.
23. **Vedic houses split the siblings.** In Jyotish, the 3rd bhava governs younger siblings and the 11th elder siblings (Wikipedia: Bhava). With twelve elder siblings and none younger, your 11th house carries the whole family load.
24. **Born in a Saturn dasha.** Vimshottari dasha counts from the Moon′s nakshatra (Wikipedia: Dasha (astrology)). Pushya is ruled by Saturn, so your life began in Saturn′s 19-year period, the same planet that rules your lagna.
25. **Tropical: Pisces rising with Jupiter on the ascendant.** Jupiter is Pisces′ traditional ruler (Wikipedia: Pisces (astrology)). Jupiter rising in its own domicile is a classic mark of protection and generosity.
26. **Hellenistic: the Lot of Siblings.** Hellenistic astrologers such as Vettius Valens used calculated ″lots″ (Wikipedia: Hellenistic astrology). Your Lot of Siblings (Asc + Jupiter − Saturn) falls at 9°25′ Aquarius, and its lord, Saturn, sits in the 3rd house of siblings **[Calculated]**. Every route to ″siblings″ in the chart leads back to Saturn.
27. **Persian-Arabic: the lots multiplied.** Medieval Arabic-language astrologers greatly expanded the Greek lots into the ″Arabic parts″ (Wikipedia: Arabic parts), including lots for brothers. That is the tradition your sibling lot comes from.
28. **Modern Western: the 3rd house is brothers, sisters and speech.** Modern house meanings join siblings, early schooling and communication in the 3rd (Wikipedia: House (astrology)). Your tropical Saturn there makes the family your first, demanding classroom.
29. **Western sidereal: two zodiacs, one sky.** Western siderealists such as Cyril Fagan and Donald Bradley revived the star-fixed zodiac in the 20th century (Wikipedia: Sidereal and tropical astrology). Your chart reads well in both: Jupiter rises in each.
30. **Uranian: the Hamburg School.** Alfred Witte′s Uranian astrology works with midpoints and planetary pictures (Wikipedia: Uranian astrology). Your Jupiter conjunct the ascendant is exactly the kind of tight personal point it emphasises.
31. **Babylonian: Jupiter was Marduk′s star.** In Mesopotamia, Jupiter was identified with Marduk, king of the gods (Wikipedia: Marduk). Your rising planet is the oldest ″king star.″
32. **Chinese: Gui, yin water day master.** In BaZi, Gui (癸) is yin water: rain, dew, mist and underground springs (Wikipedia: Heavenly Stems; BaziFlow). It is the last of the ten stems. The final stem fits the final child.

33. **Chinese: Year of the Earth Tiger.** 1998 (from early February) was a Tiger year (Wikipedia: Tiger (zodiac)). Gentle rain on a tiger: soft on the surface, bold underneath.
34. **Mesoamerican: your trecena patron is Xipe Totec.** In the 260-day count, the 13-day "week" starting 1 Dog belongs to Xipe Totec (Wikipedia: Codex Borgia). Your day, 8 Movement (= Maya 8 Kab'an), falls in that trecena **[Calculated]**.

III. Numerology, Gematria and Kabbalah

35. **Life Path 5.** Pythagorean-style numerology (a largely 20th-century system; Wikipedia: Numerology) reduces 10/13/1998 to 1+0+1+3+1+9+9+8 = 32 → 5 **[Calculated]**. Five is the number of movement and freedom, which echoes your Aztec day-sign, Movement.
36. **Your birthday number is 13.** You were born on the 13th, youngest of 13. In numerology 13 reduces to 4 (1+3), the number of foundation, and Saturn, the builder, rules your lagna.
37. **One = 13. Love = 13.** In Hebrew gematria, *echad* (one, אחד) and *ahavah* (love, אהבה) are each 13, and together they make 26, the value of the divine name YHVH (The Gematria). This is a classic interpretive pairing in Jewish thought, not a dictionary meaning. In this reading, thirteen is the number of unity and love.
38. **The Thirteen Attributes of Mercy.** In Exodus 34:6–7, God passes before Moses and proclaims the thirteen *middot* of compassion (Reform Judaism; Wikipedia). They are chanted when the ark is opened on festivals, the same ark you were born beside on Simchat Torah.
39. **Maimonides' Thirteen Principles.** The Rambam set out thirteen fundamentals of Jewish faith, recited daily as *Ani Ma'amin* (Stanford Encyclopedia; Chabad).
40. **The Zohar opens with a rose of thirteen petals.** The Zohar's first passage reads the "rose among thorns" as having thirteen petals, which it ties to the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy (Sefaria: Zohar 1:1a; Wikipedia: Zohar).
41. **Thirteen is the age of the commandments.** A boy becomes *bar mitzvah* at 13. One traditional source is that Levi was exactly 13 when the Torah first calls him *ish*, "a man" (Chabad).
42. **Death XIII is the letter Nun.** In the Golden Dawn's tarot-Kabbalah, Atu XIII is attributed to Nun (Wikipedia: Tarot card reading, Golden Dawn attributions table), which pairs Death XIII with Nun and Scorpio. Nun means "fish," which links to your Pisces rising.

IV. Judaism and the Hebrew Bible

43. **Twelve tribes that are really thirteen.** Jacob's son Joseph became two tribes, Ephraim and Manasseh, so counting both gives thirteen (Wikipedia: Twelve Tribes; Aish). The Bible keeps "twelve" by folding in or setting aside a tribe, because the thirteenth is always the extra one.
44. **Jacob had thirteen children.** Twelve sons and one daughter, Dinah (Aish). The foundational family of Israel is a family of thirteen, like yours.

45. **Benjamin, the beloved youngest.** Benjamin, Rachel's second son, was Jacob's youngest (Wikipedia: Benjamin). In Genesis the youngest is the one the father cannot let go of.
46. **David, the youngest, chosen.** Samuel passes over all of Jesse's older sons and anoints David, the youngest, who was out tending sheep (Wikipedia: David).
47. **Hoshana Rabbah came two days before you.** The festival week ran Hoshana Rabbah, then Shemini Atzeret, then Simchat Torah (Hebcal 5759). The Zohar teaches that the judgment sealed on Yom Kippur is only "delivered" at the end of Sukkot, on Hoshana Rabbah (Wikipedia: Hoshana Rabbah). You arrived right after the verdict went out, into the celebration.

V. Christianity

48. **Thirteen at the table.** Jesus and the Twelve make thirteen at the Last Supper (Wikipedia: Last Supper). This is the oldest root of the "thirteen at dinner" unease, and it starts with a table of unity.
49. **Paul, the apostle who came after the Twelve.** Paul was not one of the original Twelve but became the "apostle to the Gentiles" (Wikipedia: Paul the Apostle). Late arrival, outsized reach.
50. **Constantine, the "thirteenth apostle."** Constantine had himself entombed in Constantinople's Church of the Holy Apostles among memorials to the Twelve, and is honoured in the East as "equal to the apostles" (Wikipedia: Constantine the Great).
51. **Fátima's Miracle of the Sun happened on your birthday.** The last Fátima apparition, with the reported "dance of the sun" seen by a large crowd, was on 13 October 1917 (Wikipedia: Our Lady of Fátima). The apparitions were on the 13th of each month.
52. **St Anthony of Padua's feast is 13 June** (Wikipedia). He is patron of finding lost things, a fitting saint for the one who comes last and notices what everyone else missed.

VI. Gnosticism

53. **Sophia's home is the Thirteenth Aeon.** In the *Pistis Sophia*, Sophia lives in the thirteenth aeon, falls from it, and is restored there (Wikipedia: Pistis Sophia; Quest). In Gnostic myth, thirteen is the place Wisdom comes home to.
54. **"You will be the thirteenth."** In the *Gospel of Judas*, Jesus calls Judas "the thirteenth daimon" (spirit), set apart from the other twelve (Wikipedia: Gospel of Judas). Scholars still argue whether this makes him exalted or condemned. The thirteenth is the one who stands outside the circle.
55. **Thirteen kingdoms and the generation without a king.** The Nag Hammadi *Apocalypse of Adam* lists thirteen kingdoms' wrong accounts of the Illuminator's origin before the true "kingless generation" speaks (Wikipedia: Apocalypse of Adam).

VII. Islam

56. **Ali′s birthday is kept on 13 Rajab.** Ali was born around 600 CE, traditionally on 13 Rajab, which Shi′a Muslims celebrate every year (Wikipedia: Ali). The Prophet′s cousin and son-in-law, and the first Imam for Shi′a Muslims, carries the date thirteen.
57. **Surah 13 is "The Thunder."** The Qur′an′s thirteenth chapter is *Ar-Ra′d*, "The Thunder" (Wikipedia). Thunder is the voice of the rain, and you are a yin-water day master.
58. **The Meccan years.** Muhammad preached in Mecca from about 610 until the Hijra to Medina in 622, roughly twelve to thirteen years by the lunar count (Wikipedia: Hijrah). Tradition commonly counts this as thirteen years: the hard stretch before the new beginning.

VIII. Hinduism, Buddhism and Jainism

59. **Trayodashi belongs to Shiva.** The 13th lunar day (*trayodashi*) hosts Pradosha, the twilight fast to Shiva (Wikipedia: Pradosha). You were born at night, near twilight′s end, in a waning fortnight.
60. **Dhanteras is a 13th.** Dhanteras, the wealth-and-healing day that opens Diwali, falls on the 13th day of the dark half of Kartika/Ashvin (Wikipedia: Dhanteras). It honours Dhanvantari, the gods′ physician, which pairs with your Saturn in the Ashvins′ star.
61. **The Pandavas′ thirteenth year.** In the *Mahabharata*, the Pandavas serve twelve years of forest exile and a thirteenth year incognito before they reclaim their kingdom (Wikipedia: Mahabharata). The thirteenth is the hidden year that comes just before the turn.
62. **Thirteen ascetic practices.** Theravada Buddhism lists thirteen *dhutanga*, voluntary austerities such as eating once a day and living in the forest (Wikipedia: Dhutanga). That is Saturn′s kind of discipline, with Ketu′s renunciation.
63. **Vimalanatha, the 13th Tirthankara.** Jainism′s thirteenth ford-maker is Vimalanatha, "Lord of the Spotless" (Wikipedia). His name means purity, which fits your Virgo Atmakaraka.
64. **Jūsan-mairi, the thirteen pilgrimage.** In Kyoto, children of traditional age 13 visit Hōrin-ji to ask Kokūzō Bodhisattva for wisdom, and must not look back until they have crossed the Togetsukyō bridge (Japan Tourism Agency/MLIT). Some of the pilgrimage seasons run through October.

IX. Mesoamerica

65. **13 × 20 = 260.** The sacred 260-day count (tonalpohualli, tzolk′in) pairs thirteen numbers with twenty day-signs (Wikipedia: Tzolk′in). In Mesoamerica, thirteen was the sacred count itself, not something unlucky.
66. **The trecena: a 13-day week.** Each of the twenty 13-day "weeks" has a patron god. Xipe Totec rules the 14th, beginning 1 Dog (Wikipedia: Codex Borgia).

67. **Xipe Totec, "Our Lord the Flayed One."** His name comes from *xipehua*, to flay, peel or shell: stripping bark, husking maize, shedding skin. He is a god of renewal (Mikulska, *Ancient Mesoamerica*). The thirteenth child is the one who sheds the family's old skin.
68. **Tlacaxipehualiztli, the spring festival.** Xipe's feast marked agricultural renewal before the rains (Wikipedia: Tlacaxipehualiztli).
69. **Patron of goldsmiths.** Sahagún records Xipe Totec as patron of the gold- and silversmiths (Wikipedia: Xipe Totec). Gold is your Sun-Atmakaraka's metal too.
70. **Healer of skin and eyes.** Sahagún's informants say Xipe sent skin and eye diseases and could cure them (Mikulska). That is another healer thread, alongside the Ashvins and Dhanvantari.
71. **Thirteen heavens.** Aztec cosmology layered the upper world into thirteen heavens (Wikipedia: Thirteen Heavens). Thirteen is the ladder up.
72. **The thirteenth baktun closed in your childhood.** The Maya Long Count completed 13 baktuns on 21 December 2012 (Wikipedia: Long Count), when you were 14. The apocalypse reading was modern; the Maya saw the date as a cycle completing, and you lived through the turn.

X. Norse and Celtic

73. **Thirteen valkyries.** *Grímnismál* 36 names thirteen valkyries who carry ale to the einherjar (Voluspa.org; Wikipedia: Valkyrie).
74. **Loki as the "13th guest" is modern.** The popular tale of twelve gods at dinner and Loki arriving thirteenth to kill Baldr is not in Snorri or the *Lokasenna*. In the Prose Edda Loki tricks blind Höðr into throwing mistletoe (Wikipedia: Baldr). It is included here only to correct it.
75. **Iceland's thirteen Yule Lads.** Thirteen *jólasveinar* come down from the mountains one per night over the thirteen nights before Christmas (Wikipedia: Yule Lads).
76. **The Thirteen Treasures of the Island of Britain.** Welsh tradition lists thirteen magical treasures (*Tri Thlws ar Ddeg Ynys Prydain*), including a cauldron, a chessboard and a cloak of invisibility (Wikipedia).
77. **The 13-month "Celtic tree calendar" is modern.** The tree-month calendar comes from Robert Graves's *The White Goddess* (1948), not ancient Celts (Wikipedia: The White Goddess). It is listed as a modern creation.

XI. Egypt

78. **Osiris: fourteen pieces, thirteen recovered.** In Plutarch's version Set cuts Osiris into fourteen pieces. Isis finds every one except the phallus, which a fish swallowed (Wikipedia: Osiris). Thirteen pieces regathered, plus one missing, all bound up with fish, the Pisces image on your ascendant.

79. **The "little month."** The Egyptian civil year had twelve 30-day months plus five epagomenal days, a short extra period outside the months (Wikipedia: Egyptian calendar). On those days Osiris, Horus, Set, Isis and Nephthys were born, so the extra time is where the gods' family arrives.

XII. China

80. **The Thirteen Classics.** The Confucian canon was finalised as thirteen classics (Wikipedia: Thirteen Classics). Thirteen is the completed library.
81. **The Thirteen Tombs of the Ming.** Thirteen Ming emperors are buried in the valley north of Beijing (Wikipedia: Ming tombs).
82. **China's 13-month years.** The Chinese lunisolar calendar inserts a leap month about seven times every nineteen years (Wikipedia: Chinese calendar). That gives the same thirteen-month correction as the Hebrew calendar, found independently.

XIII. Tarot, Alchemy, Hermetism and Esoteric Orders

83. **Death, Atu XIII, means transformation.** Tarot's thirteenth trump is Death, read by modern interpreters as an ending that clears the way for change (Wikipedia: Death (tarot card)). It is a Xipe Totec card: shedding, then renewal.
84. **The card with no name.** In the Tarot of Marseilles, trump XIII is generally left unlabelled (Wikipedia: Tarot of Marseilles), and some decks call it "the Card with No Name" (Wikipedia: Death (tarot card)). It is the unnamed thirteenth.
85. **Corpus Hermeticum XIII: "On Rebirth."** The thirteenth Hermetic treatise is Hermes' secret dialogue with Tat on spiritual rebirth (Hermetic Library; Wikipedia: Corpus Hermeticum). In Hermetism, thirteen is literally the chapter of being born again.
86. **Alchemy's planetary metals.** Saturn is lead, Jupiter tin and the Sun gold (Wikipedia: Classical planet). Your chart is mostly Saturn (lagna lord, lot ruler) and Jupiter (rising), with a solar Atmakaraka: lead and tin working toward gold.
87. **Scottish Rite 13th degree: the Royal Arch of Enoch.** The 13th degree tells of a sacred Word hidden in a vault below nine arches and recovered (Wikipedia: Scottish Rite).
88. **The Great Seal's thirteens are for the states, not the Masons.** The thirteen arrows, stars, stripes and pyramid courses stand for the thirteen original states. Its designers are not known to have been Masons (Wikipedia: Great Seal).
89. **Covens of thirteen are a 1921 idea.** Margaret Murray popularised the thirteen-member witches' coven in 1921. It is not an attested medieval rule (Wikipedia: Coven).

XIV. Folklore, East and West

90. **Friday the 13th is a 19th-century superstition.** The earliest records are French, from the 1830s. Thomas Lawson's 1907 novel *Friday, the Thirteenth* spread it in America (Library of Congress Folklife; Wikipedia).
91. **The Templars were arrested on your birthday, and the "Friday 13th" origin story is modern.** Philip IV's officers seized the Knights Templar on Friday 13 October 1307 (Wikipedia: Knights Templar). Linking it to the Friday-the-13th superstition is a recent popular theory.
92. **"Triskaidekaphobia" dates from 1910.** The word appears in Isador Coriat's *Abnormal Psychology* (Wikipedia: Triskaidekaphobia).
93. **The Thirteen Club.** In 1882 Captain William Fowler founded a New York dining club that met 13 at a table on the 13th to mock the superstition (Library of Congress Folklife).
94. **The baker's dozen.** Thirteen for twelve is usually traced to medieval English bread laws that punished short weight, though the exact origin is debated (Wikipedia: Baker's dozen). The thirteenth is the generous extra.
95. **Sizdah Bedar: send the thirteenth day outdoors.** On the 13th day of Nowruz, Iranians picnic outside and throw away sprouted greens to cast off the year's bad luck (Wikipedia: Sizdah Bedar).
96. **Grimm: "The Twelve Brothers."** A king vows that if his thirteenth child is a girl, his twelve sons must die. The daughter later searches for her brothers and redeems them (Wikipedia; Grimm Stories text). In Grimm, the thirteenth child is the one who saves the siblings.
97. **Grimm: "Briar Rose" and the thirteenth wise woman.** The king owns only twelve golden plates, so the thirteenth wise woman is left out and curses the princess (Wikipedia: Sleeping Beauty). The thirteenth is powerful because she was overlooked.
98. **Argentina's presidential godchildren.** Since 1907, a seventh son (and since 1973 a seventh daughter) can become the president's godchild. The custom came from Volga German immigrants; the "werewolf" explanation is a later conflation (The Guardian). As a 13th child you are well past the seventh, in folklore's language a child of surplus.

XV. Birth Order, History and Famous Thirteenths

99. **Birth order, the lastborn and the science.** Alfred Adler put birth order at the centre of personality (Wikipedia: Alfred Adler), and Frank Sulloway's *Born to Rebel* argued that later-borns are the innovators (Wikipedia: Frank Sulloway). The largest modern study (Rohrer et al., *PNAS* 2015, about 20,000 people) found birth order's measurable trace is in intellect, not temperament (doi). Strachan's 1989 *BMJ* paper also found hay fever less common in children with many older siblings, the seed of the "hygiene hypothesis" (doi; Wikipedia). Twelve older siblings is about as much "hygiene hypothesis" as a childhood can hold.

100. **The youngest inherits the hearth, and the thirteenth-born keep making history.** Under ultimogeniture and the English custom of Borough English, the youngest son inherited the family home (Wikipedia: Borough English; Ultimogeniture). Among the Mongols the youngest son, Tolui, kept his father Genghis Khan′s home base and became regent (Wikipedia: Tolui). Famous thirteenths include **Josiah Wedgwood**, ″thirteenth and last child,″ just like you (Wikipedia); **Ignatius of Loyola**, youngest of thirteen and founder of the Jesuits (Wikipedia); and **Archduke Johann of Austria**, thirteenth child of Emperor Leopold II (Wikipedia). Your own date, 13 October, is the day the White House cornerstone was laid (1792; Wikipedia) and the day the International Meridian Conference voted for Greenwich as the prime meridian (1884; conference proceedings, Project Gutenberg). It was a day for laying foundations and setting the zero point. Your birthplace is Johnstown, marked by the 1889 flood that killed 2,209 people (Wikipedia: Johnstown Flood), and your nation began as thirteen colonies (Wikipedia) whose Thirteenth Amendment ended slavery (Wikipedia). For a gui-water child, that history weighs heavily, and the thirteen-colony one is about beginning again.

Sources: mostly Wikipedia for orientation, backed by primary or scholarly sources where available (Hebcal, the Grímnismál text, the 1884 Meridian proceedings, Mikulska in Ancient Mesoamerica, *PNAS, BMJ, the Library of Congress). Calendar conversions computed with* `convertdate` *and Skyfield DE421.*